

A FAITHFUL PATH COMMUNITY GUIDE

The Christian Spiritual Reset

*A 3-Day Guided Retreat to Overcome Burnout,
Hear God Clearly, and Renew Your Faith*

Pastor Richmond Kobe

FAITHFUL PATH COMMUNITY

Copyright

The Christian Spiritual Reset: A 3-Day Guided Retreat to Overcome Burnout, Hear God Clearly, and Renew Your Faith Copyright © 2026 Richmond Kobe. All rights reserved.

Published by Faithful Path Community,
faithfulpathcommunity.com. First edition, 2026.

No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored, or transmitted in any form without the prior written permission of the author, except for brief quotations in reviews and for the personal, non- commercial use of the purchaser, including printing the session pages for use on retreat.

Scripture quotations are from the ESV® Bible (The Holy Bible, English Standard Version®), © 2001 by Crossway, a publishing ministry of Good News Publishers. ESV Text Edition: 2025. The ESV text may not be quoted in any publication made available to the public by a Creative Commons license. The ESV may not be translated in whole or in part into any other language. Used by permission. All rights reserved. Where another translation is used, it is identified.

This book offers pastoral guidance. It is not medical, psychological, psychiatric, or legal advice, and it is not a substitute for professional care. See the note below and the Resources page at the back.

Contact: info@faithfulpathcommunity.com

SESSION TEN

Returning With a New Rhythm

Day 3, late afternoon

Before you begin

This is the last session, and it should be done settled, not rushed. If you have come to it straight from Session Seven, or from Eight or Nine, make sure you have eaten and rested first. Set aside at least an unhurried hour, with flexibility for more time or a short break. If fatigue rises, divide the session rather than rushing to finish, and leave the evening free afterwards.

Gather the practical and discernment materials from the retreat: your journal; the intention from Chapter 7; your Chapter 1 and Chapter 4 answers; the Act, Share, Entrust, and Seek-counsel cards from Session Three; the "What I sense" card from Session Seven; the identity card from Session Eight and the purpose card from Session Nine, if you did those; and the sealed envelope from Session One, the one marked *Not until Day 3*. Do not open it yet. Keep the confession, release, and any trauma-related envelopes sealed and secure; this session does not reopen them. Do not display or transport sensitive writing where another person could discover it.

If you deferred sessions, this session is still for you. It does not assume you did all ten. It assumes you came, and stayed, and are now going home.

Central passage

1 Kings 19:19–21, followed by **Luke 10:17–20** Read both. In the first, notice what Elijah's return from isolation looks like. In the second, notice what Jesus tells the returning disciples to rejoice in.

Teaching

Elijah's encounter at Horeb ends with the instruction, "Go, return on your way." His wider story continues as he leaves the mountain, and his next recorded action is to find Elisha ploughing in a field and throw his cloak over him. Elisha asks to say goodbye to his parents, then follows. God's response to Elijah's isolation had included food, rest, honest encounter, and the knowledge that seven thousand remained; now it includes Elisha as successor and companion in the work. Elijah returns from isolation to active life knowing he is not the only faithful person left. Isolation begins to give way to shared vocation.

Chapter 2 said that the difference between running away and retreating is that a retreat intends to return. This is the returning. It matters as much as the leaving. Re-entry is where the insights of a retreat meet the pressures of ordinary life, and without support or structural change, old patterns can quickly reassert themselves. An interruption can provide genuine rest and insight; its longer-term influence grows when at least one ordinary pattern changes in response.

So this session is not about resolutions. It is about rhythm. Across the Gospels, Jesus' ministry includes both engagement and withdrawal: teaching, healing, prayer, solitude, meals, travel, and rest. In **Mark 6:30–32**, the disciples return from their mission, report to him, and he says, "Come away by yourselves to a desolate place and rest a while." Then the crowds find them, the work resumes, and later he withdraws again. This is a pattern of

life, not a timetable every reader must reproduce identically. What you take home from these three days is not a peak experience to remember. It is a small, repeatable pattern that lets some of what happened here happen again, in ordinary weeks. Part Five will help you build it. Today you choose its first piece.

Then there is Luke 10. The larger group of disciples returns from their mission rejoicing: even the demons submit to them. Jesus does not dismiss it, but he redirects it: "do not rejoice in this, that the spirits are subject to you, but rejoice that your names are written in heaven." For those who belong to Christ, the deepest reason for rejoicing is not the quality of a retreat experience but God's saving grace and the belonging Christ gives. Belonging to him is not earned by a successful retreat or a productive ministry. Service grows from grace; it does not purchase it. If the three days were dry, that belonging is not diminished. If they were rich, that is not what to build on.

Your return may likewise require appropriate companionship: a friend, a spouse, a pastor, a counsellor, a colleague, a recovery community, or professional support. Elijah's return included shared life and shared work. The retreat's insistence on a support person was never only about the three days.

Two things about re-entry, and then the work.

First, expect a dip. Many people feel unusually clear and calm in the last hours of a retreat, and then, sometime in the first days home, flat, irritable, or discouraged. In my pastoral experience this is common, and it does not mean the retreat has worn off. It means the contrast between the quiet and the noise is real, and your body and mind are readjusting. Part Five's first days are designed for this. Do not judge the entire value of the retreat solely by your mood during the first week. However, take severe

distress, worsening depression, inability to function, or safety concerns seriously and seek appropriate help.

Second, share selectively and safely. There is a temptation, on the way home, to tell everyone what changed and what you are going to do differently. Some of it will not survive contact with ordinary life, and some of it, as Session Seven said, still needs testing. Tell your designated support person what would help them support you. If you have a safe spouse or partner, explain any practical rhythm that may affect shared life and listen to their concerns. Keep private material private, but bring significant impressions or decisions to appropriately qualified counsel rather than treating secrecy as spirituality. Elijah's next step was not public announcement but embodied obedience and shared work.

Opening the envelope

Now open the envelope from Session One.

Read the cards. These are the ordinary demands you set down on the first morning. Some will feel exactly as heavy as they did; some, you may notice, feel lighter, or have resolved themselves, or turned out to be smaller than they seemed. Some may have become clearer.

Sort them, using the Session Three marks: **A** for something within your responsibility that needs a next faithful action, **S** for something to share, **E** for something to entrust, **?** for something needing counsel. Do not assume every card must return to you as an action. Some may need delegation, counsel, changed expectations, or no action at all. Anything that no longer needs to be done, set aside.

If a card concerns immediate safety, medical care, suicidal thoughts, abuse, safeguarding, or a genuine crisis, do not place it

into the ordinary thirty-day plan. Seek the appropriate help promptly.

You are picking these up again. But you are picking them up after three days of practising how to carry things, and you may find that you hold them differently.

Self-assessment

In your journal:

1. Reread the three questions you answered at the end of Chapter 1, and your answers. Then reread your intention from Chapter 7, all four parts. Without forcing it: what has shifted, what has become clearer, and what may still need attention, support, prayer, or discernment after you return? Write honestly, including "nothing yet" if that is true. Chapter 1 told you that you would read these again; this is not a test of whether the retreat worked.
2. Lay out the practical and discernment cards together. What do you notice? Is there a theme, a person who appears more than once, a concern that keeps returning? A repeated theme is worth noticing, but repetition alone does not prove that it is God's central message. It may indicate anxiety, an intrusive concern, an unmet need, or a genuine priority requiring further discernment.
3. Was there a moment, exercise, rest period, conversation, or passage that seems especially important? If nothing stands out yet, write that.
4. What are you afraid will happen when you get home?

Guided prayer

Use only the lines that fit. Change or omit the others.

*Lord, you told Elijah to return, and you showed him
that he was not alone.*

I am going back, unfinished and still held by your grace.

Thank you for what these days contained: -----.

*What remains unclear, help me carry patiently and test
wisely.*

*Give me appropriate companionship, and help me
receive it.*

*Go with me into ordinary life, and teach me to
recognise your presence there.*

Give me a rhythm rather than a dramatic resolution.

Amen.

Silence

Suggested length: ten minutes, or the length you can manage.

Anchor phrase: **"Go, return on your way."** Or: **"I am not alone."**

This is the last silence of the retreat. Spend it not looking back and not planning ahead. Simply be here, one more time, with the God who was here the whole time. The retreat setting will remain behind, but the practice of returning attention to God can travel with you. It may look smaller and less quiet at home, and it can still be real.

When the timer ends, take one unhurried breath before moving. If you want to remain longer, you may; if you are ready to stop, stop.

Journaling

1. What did you notice in the last silence?
2. Of everything that happened, what one thing do you most want to be true in a month's time? Write it as a sentence beginning "In a month, I hope..."

3. Who will you tell about the retreat, and what will you tell them? Who will you not tell yet, and why?
4. What is the next deliberate pause or form of support you need? It might be a three-hour reset, a day retreat, a counselling appointment, a Sabbath practice, or a protected hour. Write it down. A rhythm needs a next time.

Practical exercise: four things to take home

Older Christian traditions sometimes use the phrase "rule of life" for a realistic pattern of prayer, rest, work, worship, and relationship. "Rule" here means a supportive framework, not a system for earning God's approval. Part Five will help you build one. Today you take home four things, each on one card.

One thing to entrust. From the Entrust cards, or the envelope, choose the single matter you most need to stop trying to control. Write it on a card with the words "placed in God's care."

One action to take. From the Act cards, the purpose card, or the envelope, choose one next faithful step, doable in the first two weeks home. Small, specific, within your control.

One person or source of support. Name the person, or the service, you will contact in the first week. Your support person, your Eli, a counsellor, a doctor, a recovery community. Write when you will contact them.

One sustainable rhythm. Choose one piece of a rule of life and commit to it for thirty days. Choose something small enough for a difficult ordinary week; in a crisis, illness, or emergency, the rhythm may need to pause without guilt. Choose a rhythm

compatible with your health, household, work, caregiving responsibilities, and safety. Options, all adaptable:

- **A daily quiet.** Up to ten minutes, at a roughly fixed time, with a psalm and a short silence. The Chapter 8 practice, continued.
- **A weekly hour.** One protected hour each week, phone away, alone with God; shorter blocks count if an hour is impossible.
- **A digital boundary.** One element of Chapter 9 kept permanently, with emergency access preserved.
- **A protected period of ceasing.** A day, or half a day, each week without your ordinary work, adapted for caregivers, shift workers, and medical needs. Part Five gives Sabbath the fuller treatment it deserves; for these thirty days, simply protect the time.
- **A conversation.** A regular meeting with a trustworthy and competent person in which you say honestly how you are.
- **A rest that is yours.** A named thing that restores you, protected weekly without guilt; recreation, not compulsive escape. Write the rhythm on a card, with the day, the time, and the place, as concretely as you can. Write underneath what you will do when you miss it, because you will: "When I miss it, I will start again the next day without guilt." Read the four cards to God.

Then sort every card from the retreat into two groups. **Action cards:** the four you have just written, plus any Act, Share, and Seek-counsel cards that are safe, practical reminders. Carry these in an accessible place; Part Five's 30-day plan begins with them on Day 1. **Private cards:** anything sensitive, identifying, traumatic, or spiritually intimate, including the sealed envelopes. Seal or securely store these. If your belongings may be searched

or monitored, do not carry written material that could place you at risk.

If you deferred sessions, write on a card "Optional sessions to revisit" and include only those you genuinely want to reconsider. Deferral may be the final wise decision, not incomplete work. The 30-day plan has a place for them if you want it.

Closing declaration

Read only what you can say honestly. Adjust the words if you need to.

*I came as honestly as I could, and grace met me here.
I am returning with some clarity and some unfinished
questions.
I will not carry ordinary life alone.
I take one small rhythm and one next faithful step.
My retreat experience is not the measure of God's
faithfulness.
(Optional:) My name is written in heaven, and that is
what I will rejoice in.*

A blessing

These words were given to Israel's priests as a blessing over the people (Numbers 6:24–26), and they have been spoken over God's people for millennia. Receive them now as Scripture's ancient words of blessing, aloud if you can.

*The LORD bless you and keep you; the LORD make his
face to shine upon you and be gracious to you; the
LORD lift up his countenance upon you and give you
peace.*

Notes

Space for anything else you want to record from this session, and from the retreat as a whole.

After Session Ten: the retreat is over. Do not add anything to it. Have a simple meal and pack slowly. Do not rush your departure. Follow the location's checkout requirements, but delay travel or ask for assistance if you are tired, emotionally overwhelmed, unwell, or unable to drive safely. Tell your support person your travel plan and confirm when you arrive. You do not need to explain the whole retreat immediately; tell them what they need to know to support your return, and save deeper reflection for when you are rested.

Part Five begins on your first morning home. Read Chapter 13 that day if you can, and not before. You have done enough for now.